

What Your Union Secured

2026 Draft Memorandum of Agreement — Summary for Members

★ **Ratification vote required.** The MOA (dated May 22, 2026) takes effect only upon a membership YES vote. Until ratified, existing terms remain in effect. **Check your Utica email for voting instructions.**

Six months of intensive negotiations — 34+ hours in April and 68.5 hours in May alone — grounded in member surveys, grievance data, retrenchment meeting feedback, and advice from AAUP national financial experts and our labor lawyer. Here is what your union secured.

01 Shared Sacrifice, Financial Resilience

Defined contribution — with a legally binding salary growth roadmap through 2030

- **Salary freeze:** AY 2026–27 salaries frozen at January 2026 levels (3.5% below temporarily restored levels) — a finite, defined contribution, not open-ended.
- **Growth roadmap:** 2.5% raise in AY 2027–28 • 2.75% in 2028–29 • 3.0% in 2029–30, plus fixed-dollar additions and DOE benchmark bonuses. All contractually binding.
- **Retirement:** Employer retirement contributions temporarily reduced starting August 2026, with full restoration to original amounts by August 1, 2029 — legally binding. Your tier status is not affected during the reduction period.

02 Voluntary & Involuntary Separation Options

For the first time, if you're retrenched, you choose what comes next

- **If retrenched:** Option A — Severance: 3 months gross salary + 12 months continued health insurance. Unemployment will not be contested.
- Option B — Half-Time Off-Ramp: Work half-load for one full academic year at half salary, full benefits. Unemployment will not be contested at the end.
- Option C — Retirement: If CBA-eligible, receive all retirement benefits + university covers your health insurance contributions for up to 3 years.
- **All options include:** Under all three options: full reimbursement of all salary and retirement reductions from AY 2024–25, 2025–26, and 2026–27, plus tuition benefits for you and your immediate family.
- **Voluntary options:** Transitional Sabbatical (new): At least 2 guaranteed per year. 10+ years of service, commit to December 31 retirement → full semester at full pay, no duties. Apply by January 25.
- Voluntary Half-Time Off-Ramp: Up to 2 years at half-load, half-salary, full benefits, full rank. Meeting attendance and admissions events are explicitly not expected during the off-ramp.

03 First-Ever AI Protections

Nine new contractual protections governing how the university may use AI

- No AI surveillance of your performance or evaluation.
- No AI in tenure, promotion, reappointment, discipline, or grievance decisions.
- Right to opt out of any AI platform without penalty — as long as you can still meet contractual obligations.
- No AI monitoring of protected union organizing or concerted activity.
- 120-day advance notice before any new AI educational technology or learning analytics tool is implemented.
- University cannot authorize third parties to mine or train algorithms on your personally identifiable information (PII).
- Joint Labor Management Technology Task Force established to evaluate AI procurement and its impact on working conditions.

04 Streamlined Workload

Fewer reviews, fewer hoops, fewer pressure points

- **Tenure track:** Years 1 and 4 of the tenure track are now automatic reappointments — you cannot be non-renewed in those years except for just cause or retrenchment.

- **Tenure + promotion:** For TT faculty hired on or after August 1, 2026: tenure = simultaneous promotion. One application, one set of meetings, one decision.
- **Emeritus:** Emeritus status granted automatically upon meeting criteria (10+ years, good standing, irrevocable retirement declaration) — no faculty vote required. Retroactive for those retired on or before May 31, 2026.
- **Outside employment:** Prior Provost approval before taking paid outside professional work is eliminated. If an actual conflict arises, you must be met with first, may bring a union rep, and may continue the work during any appeal.

05 Addressing Administrative Overreach

Non-attendance at meetings can no longer be used against you

- **Meeting attendance:** Non-attendance at Faculty Senate, university meetings, Commencement, and Convocation shall not be used punitively in any disciplinary procedure.
- All meetings must provide a remote option where possible.
- **Admissions events:** The requirement to attend at least one on-campus admissions event per year is fully stricken.

06 Increased Transparency & Accountability

More visibility into finances, committees, and how decisions are made

- **Financial transparency:** University must provide AAUP-Utica with audited financial statements, the DOE financial ratio calculation, and the Debt Service Coverage Ratio.
- **Committee transparency:** Twice each year, the university must publish a complete roster of all non-departmental committees, task forces, and workgroups — including purpose, every member's name and affiliation, how they were selected, and the expected end date.
- **Expanded union voice:** AAUP-Utica representation in Meet & Discuss meetings increases from 2 to 4 members, with jointly prepared agendas.

07 New Benefit: On-Campus Housing Option

A practical option for faculty in transition or new hires

- Bargaining unit members may request on-campus housing in University residential facilities through Human Resources, first-come first-served basis.
- Private bathroom included. University's standard monthly rate less a 10% member discount. Term-based agreements (Fall, Spring, Summer), renewable each semester.

Vote YES to Ratify

Voting instructions will arrive via your Utica University email. If you haven't received them, contact your AAUP-Utica representative.

Questions? Full details, sources, and your rights at: <https://aauputica.org/contract-guide>